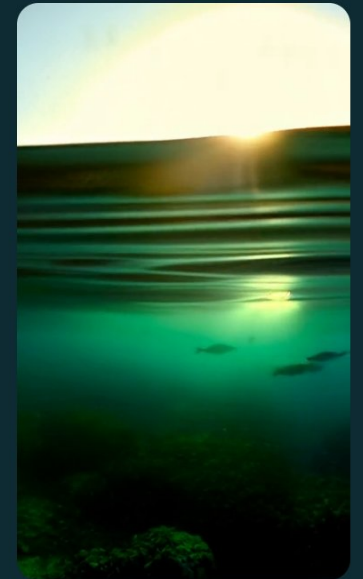


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Silent Tides

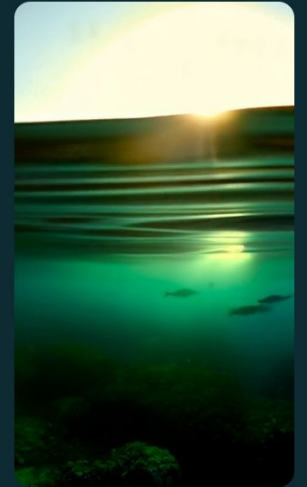
A 35-second climate film about coral bleaching, generated in ComfyUI

Lan Dinh & Evaldas



Watch first

Play the film: youtu.be/nW8UBwSlesA



7 shots + AI-disclosure end card · every frame generated in ComfyUI · AI voiceover made in ComfyUI

THE PROBLEM

84%

of the world's coral reefs were hit by bleaching-level heat stress

1 Jan 2023 – 30 Mar 2025 · 82 countries · the fourth and most intense global bleaching event. This isn't a forecast, it already happened.

Who it's for, and who it isn't

For

Dutch/EU 18–30-year-olds who accept climate change but see it as slow and far away

They watch on a phone, often with the sound off, and decide in about 3 seconds whether to keep watching. The film is placed in Reels, Shorts and TikTok.

Not for

Marine biologists and policy experts: 35 seconds is far too simple for them.

Climate deniers: the film takes climate change as given.

Young children: the bleached-reef shot is deliberately bleak.

The story in four beats



1 • Beauty

Make people care about the reef first



2 • Cause

Heat arrives and the colour drains



3 • Consequence

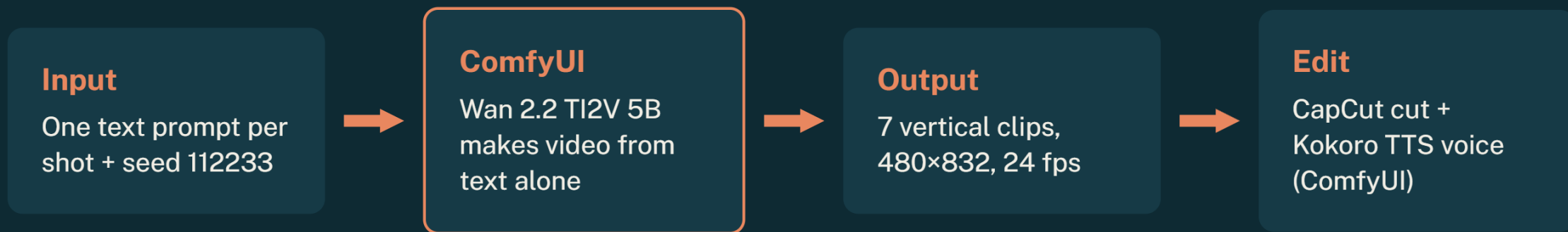
A white, silent reef



4 • Agency

Recovery is possible if the heat stops

From text to film in ComfyUI



Steps / CFG	Sampler	Frames per shot	Seed
13 / 5.0	uni_pc, simple	97 (113 for shots 4 & 7)	112233, fixed

WHAT BROKE

Shot 4 took 6 attempts

Didn't work (5 renders)

"coral polyp, zooxanthellae expelled as fine particles, tissue turning translucent"

Worked

"coral ... turning white like rock, then bone-white skeleton"

Lesson: describe what it looks like, not the biology.



The risks, and what we did

Risk	What it would mean for viewers	What we did
Taken for real footage	Shared as "the Great Barrier Reef now" and debunked, which hurts trust in real reef footage	No real place named; end card says "The video and voice is AI generated. The statistics are real and sourced."
AI voice sounds real	Viewers assume an expert or organisation is speaking	Stock Kokoro voice, not a clone; disclosed on the end card
Emotional manipulation	Despair makes young people tune out	Partial, conditional recovery, not doom and not a fake happy ending
Training data used without consent	Photographers' work used to train Wan, unpaid	Non-commercial project; stated openly in the README

What the film cost in energy

15

clips rendered, 7 kept

2.9 h

GPU time, one RX
6950 XT

1.2

kWh $\approx$ one washing-
machine cycle

0.3

kg CO₂ on the Dutch grid

Only about a quarter of the GPU time went into the 7 clips in the film. Next time we'd test prompts as short, low-resolution clips first.

What we learned

Form follows the problem: underwater, short, vertical, sound-off.

Prompt for the look, not the science: the model draws what you can see.

Realistic AI imagery needs a label: the images inform only when viewers know they're generated.

Questions?

